

AFL-CIO LEGISLATIVE SCORECARD

2014

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard>
Retrieved 8 August 2026
Records 11 House, 10 Senate

HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

1. ALERRT Act of 2014

H.R. 2804 · February 27, 2014
Position Bad for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 236 NAYs 179
The Achieving Less Excess in Regulation and Requiring Transparency Act (ALERRT) combined four measures, all of which were designed to stop, delay, or weaken new protections. The Regulatory Accountability Act (RAA) is the most far-reaching of these measures, overriding requirements of landmark legislation such as the Occupational Safety and Health Act (OSHA) and the Mine Safety and Health Act (MSHA). Its primary goal was limiting costs and the impact on businesses and corporations; protections for workers and the general public were a distant second. Rather than improving the regulatory process, this package would cripple it by further tilting the process in favor of business groups and making it more difficult to protect the health and safety of workers and the public. The bill passed.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2014/house/alerrt-act-2014>

2. FY2015 Budget Resolution

H.Con.Res. 96 · April 10, 2014
Position Bad for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 219 NAYs 205
This budget resolution would cut taxes for millionaires and corporations that send jobs overseas, and pay for those tax cuts by cutting programs that serve the middle class and low-income families. H. Con. Res 96 would cut education, research, infrastructure, and other critical investments by 30 percent over 10 years: higher education by \$260 billion over 10 years; K-12 education by \$85 billion; and Medicaid by \$732 billion. H. Con. Res. 96 would also cut transportation investment by \$52 billion in FY 2015 alone. Finally, the budget would also turn Medicare into a voucher program, raise the Medicare eligibility age to 67, and repeal the Affordable Care Act (ACA). The resolution passed.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2014/house/fy2015-budget-resolution>

3. Amendment to Prohibit Department of Defense Insourcing Functions

H.R. 4435 · May 22, 2014
Position Bad for working people
Outcome Failed YEAs 179 NAYs 244
Amendment offered by Rep. Lynn Jenkins (R-Ks.) to H.R. 4435, the 2015 National Defense Authorization Act (NDAA), that would effectively prohibit the Department of Defense (DoD) from insourcing functions that were performed by contractor employees before the date of NDAA's enactment. DoD would be forced to use contractors for the performance of inherently governmental functions until a new cost comparison process is developed—regardless of the increased risk to the public interest. DoD would never be able to stop using contractors for many functions—regardless the increased risk to the public. DoD would never be able to correct - through insourcing - contracts that cost too much or are poorly performed - regardless of the increased costs to the taxpayers. The amendment was rejected.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2014/house/amendment-prohibit-department-defense-insourcing-functions>

4. Amendment to Prevent Contracts with Fair Labor Standard Violators

H.R. 4660 · May 30, 2014
Position Good for working people
Outcome Failed YEAs 196 NAYs 211
This amendment would bar the use of funds provided by the bill to enter into contracts with vendors in violation of fair labor standards. The amendment was rejected.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2014/house/amendment-prevent-contracts-fair-labor-standard-violators>

5. Amendment to Defund Amtrak

H.R. 4745 · June 9, 2014

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Failed YEAs 154 NAYs 248

This amendment undermines Amtrak's ability to provide the rail service upon which passengers and communities have come to rely. Rep. Paul Broun's amendment would arbitrarily cut Amtrak's operating funding by \$34 million. The base bill already makes unacceptable cuts to Amtrak's capital budget, endangering the efficiency of the system and delaying urgently needed improvements to infrastructure and rail cars that are urgently needed. This amendment is particularly ill-advised at a time when Amtrak is setting ridership records year after year and recent polling shows that the railroad has broad public support across the country. The amendment was rejected.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2014/house/amendment-defund-amtrak>

6. Amendment to Defund California's High-Speed Rail Project

H.R. 4745 · June 10, 2014

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 227 NAYs 186

This amendment singles out one project in a single state—California's high-speed rail—from receiving any funds appropriated in a bill that was supposed to fund our nation's transportation needs. This project would create and sustain good-paying jobs at a time when employment opportunities are still too limited and our economic recovery remains fragile. Completion of this project would provide California residents and visitors an efficient transportation option and provide access to multi-modal connections that are urgently needed. The amendment passed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2014/house/amendment-defund-californias-high-speed-rail-project>

7. Amendment to Limit Federal Employees' Collective Bargaining Rights

H.R. 4745 · June 10, 2014

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Failed YEAs 167 NAYs 254

This amendment would bar the use of funds provided by the bill to pay a federal employee during any period when that employee is using "official time" to represent a union or its bargaining unit employees. The Gingrey Amendment would serve no purpose but to erode collective bargaining rights for civil service federal employees at greater cost to American taxpayers. Union representation for employees working their way through administrative procedures is a cost-effective process for administrating and adjudicating agency policies. The alternative to official time is for government agencies to needlessly pay for costly third party attorney and arbitrator fees. Using this time for internal union business is strictly prohibited by law: under current law, official time may not be used to solicit membership, conduct internal union meetings, elect union officers, or engage in partisan political activities. The notion that official time is used for these purposes is blatantly false. The amendment was rejected.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2014/house/amendment-limit-federal-employees-collective-bargaining-rights>

8. Amendment to Repeal Prevailing Wage Laws

H.R. 4923 · July 10, 2014

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Failed YEAs 181 NAYs 239

This amendment by Rep. Steve King (R-Iowa) to the Energy and Water Development Act, 2015 (H.R. 4923) would have repealed Davis-Bacon coverage for projects funded under this bill. The Davis-Bacon Act requires companies to pay construction workers locally prevailing wages on federally funded projects. The amendment failed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2014/house/amendment-repeal-prevailing-wage-laws>

9. Child Tax Credit Improvement Act of 2014

H.R. 4935 · July 25, 2014

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 237 NAYs 173

This legislation expands eligibility for the Child Tax Credit (CTC) by raising the threshold to \$150,000 per year, but fails to permanently extend an expiring provision that allows low income families to access the credit. Over 60 percent of families using the refundable CTC earn less than \$25,000 per year. Nearly half of these families are raising children on wages of \$10 an hour or less. Failing to permanently extend access for low-income families could take money out of the pockets of working families and hurt children at a time when child poverty is at its highest level in decades. The legislation would also deny the refundable portion of the credit to immigrants who file taxes with an IRS-issued Individual Tax Identification Number (ITIN) and are currently eligible, resulting in

over two million working families and 5.5 million children being denied the credit, 4.5 million of whom are U.S. citizens. The legislation passed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2014/house/child-tax-credit-improvement-act-2014>

10. Secure the Southwest Border Supplemental Appropriations Act, 2014

H.R. 5230 · August 1, 2014

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 223 NAYs 189

The AFL-CIO opposed the Supplemental Border Appropriations bill. While additional funding was necessary to care for child refugees arriving in 2014 from Central America, the funding levels in H.R. 5230 did not adequately ensure that children eligible for protective status were identified and not returned to dangerous situations. The legislation also included harmful policy changes that compromised due process and ran counter to established U.S. and international norms regarding the detainment of children and refugees. The bill passed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2014/house/secure-southwest-border-supplemental-appropriations-act-2014>

11. Prohibition of Funding for Deferred Action for Childhood Arrivals

H.R. 5272 · August 1, 2014

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 216 NAYs 192

In June 2012, the Obama Administration created the Deferred Action for Childhood Arrivals (DACA) by executive action. The program protects immigrant youth who arrived in the US prior to June 2007 from deportation and provides two year work-authorization. The AFL-CIO strongly supports DACA and opposed H.R. 5272 which, if enacted, would have denied funding to issue deferred action and work permits to any new or pending DACA-eligible youth applicants. The legislation was passed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2014/house/prohibition-funding-deferred-action-childhood-arrivals>

SENATE

1. Confirmation of Robert L. Wilkins for U.S. Court of Appeals Judge

January 13, 2014

Position Good for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 55 NAYs 43

Confirmation of President Barack Obama's nomination of Robert L. Wilkins of the District of Columbia to be a judge for the U.S. Court of Appeals for the District of Columbia Circuit. The nomination was confirmed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2014/senate/confirmation-robert-l-wilkins-us-court-appeals-judge>

2. National Defense Authorization Act for FY2015

H.R. 3979 · April 7, 2014

Position Good for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 59 NAYs 38

This bill extended eligibility for expanded unemployment benefits through May 31, 2014. The bill also prohibited individuals with adjusted gross incomes of \$1 million or more from receiving benefits. The bill passed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2014/senate/national-defense-authorization-act-fy2015>

3. Paycheck Fairness Act

S. 2199 · April 9, 2014

Position Good for working people

Outcome Failed YEAs 53 NAYs 44

The Paycheck Fairness Act would have required employers to demonstrate that wage gaps between men and women doing the same work were actually due to factors besides gender. It also would have prohibited retaliation against workers who shared salary information or inquired about their employers' wage practices. The bill would have brought Equal Pay Act remedies and class action procedures into conformance with those available for other civil rights claims, and required the Labor Department to provide training and collect wage information. The bill failed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2014/senate/paycheck-fairness-act>

4. Minimum Wage Fairness Act

S. 2223 · April 30, 2014
Position Good for working people
Outcome Failed YEAs 54 NAYs 42
This bill would have increased the federal minimum wage from \$7.25 to \$10.10 by 2016. It would have gradually increased the minimum cash wage for workers who receive tips until it equaled 70% of the federal minimum wage for other workers. The bill failed.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2014/senate/minimum-wage-fairness-act>

5. Cloture Motion: Bank on Students Emergency Loan Refinancing Act

S. 2432 · June 11, 2014
Position Good for working people
Outcome Failed YEAs 56 NAYs 38
Student Loan Refinancing: Republicans in the Senate blocked discussion of Sen. Elizabeth Warren's (D-Mass.) Bank on Students Emergency Loan Refinancing Act when they rejected a motion to consider debate on a bill that would allow eligible borrowers to refinance their student loans. The amendment was rejected.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2014/senate/cloture-motion-bank-students-emergency-loan-refinancing-act>

6. Confirmation of Pamela Harris for U.S. Circuit Court of Appeals Judge

July 28, 2014
Position Good for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 50 NAYs 43
Confirmation of President Barack Obama's nomination of Pamela Harris of Maryland to be a judge for the 4th U.S. Circuit Court of Appeals. The nomination was confirmed.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2014/senate/confirmation-pamela-harris-us-circuit-court-app-eals-judge>

7. Amendment to Reauthorize the Highway Trust Fund

H.R. 5021 · July 29, 2014
Position Good for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 66 NAYs 31
Senator Carper amendment that reauthorized federal-aid highway and transit programs through Dec. 19, 2014, and compelled Congress to attempt to find a long-term funding solution before the end of the year. The amendment passed.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2014/senate/amendment-reauthorize-highway-trust-fund>

8. Amendment to Cut Funding for the Federal Highway and Transit Program

H.R. 5021 · July 29, 2014
Position Bad for working people
Outcome Failed YEAs 28 NAYs 69
A dangerous amendment by Senator Lee that would have drastically reduced already insufficient funding for the federal highway and transit program from \$37.6 billion to \$7.6 billion. The amendment was rejected.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2014/senate/amendment-cut-funding-federal-highway-and-transit-program>

9. Bring Jobs Home Act

S. 2569 · July 30, 2014
Position Good for working people
Outcome Failed YEAs 54 NAYs 42
A bill that would have given businesses a tax credit for up to 20% of the expenses incurred by bringing work done in foreign countries back into the United States, provided the business also increased its number of full-time employees. It also would have prohibited tax deductions for expenses incurred when moving jobs outside the United States. The bill failed.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2014/senate/bring-jobs-home-act>

10. Emergency Supplemental Appropriations Act, 2014

	S. 2648 · July 30, 2014
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 63 NAYs 33
	Appropriations bill that allocated \$3.6 billion in supplemental appropriations, including \$2.73 billion to assist immigrant children and \$615 million for wildfire suppression. The bill contained emergency funding to care for child refugees from Central America. It included funding to help identify children eligible for protective status to ensure they would not be returned to dangerous situations. The bill passed.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2014/senate/emergency-supplemental-appropriations-act-2014